

Radiologic Technologist



Career

- Radiologic Technologists provide imaging services to help diagnose injuries and illnesses
- Work in hospitals, clinics, and imaging centers
- Use equipment like X-ray machines and CT scanners
- Position patients correctly to get clear images
- Follow safety procedures to limit radiation exposure
- Work closely with doctors to support diagnosis

Foothill College

Foothill College is a community college in California that is more affordable than a 4 year university and offers a program to become a Radiologic Technologist. Students learn in class and get hands on hospital experience, and after about 2 years they can take a test to become certified.



Fresno City College

Fresno City College is a community college in California that has a low-cost program for becoming a Radiologic Technologist. Students take classes and train in hospitals, and in about 2 years they can finish the program and take a certification exam.



A person's hand is shown drawing on a whiteboard with a marker. In the foreground, a medical syringe is visible. The background is blurred, showing what appears to be a classroom or laboratory setting with other people and equipment.

How long it takes to complete schooling?

The main Radiologic Technology programs at both schools take about two years to finish after you get accepted.



What type of degree is needed?

To become a Radiologic Technologist, you need to earn at least an associate degree. You can pursue a Bachelor's degree to increase your competitiveness for management or specialized roles.

Cost of schooling

Fresno City College: \$5,720

Foothill College: \$8,566

Certification needed

- National Certification (ARRT): You have to pass a national test to become a Radiologic Technologist. This shows you are qualified for the job.
- California State License (CRT): You also need a state license to work in California. You cannot take X-rays without it.
- Fluoroscopy Permit: You need an extra permit to do live X-ray procedures. Most schools include this training in the program.
- Associate Degree: You must complete a 2-year degree before you can get certified or licensed.
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Certification Prices

- \$225 — ARRT Exam Fee: This is what you pay once to take your national certification test.
- \$112 — California License (CRT): This is the fee to apply for your state license to work in California.
- \$112 — Fluoroscopy Permit: This is the fee for the extra permit needed to do live X-ray procedures.
- \$449 — Total Cost: This is the total amount you pay to get fully certified.

Difficulty

To become a Radiologic Technologist, the ARRT national exam is very hard and covers anatomy, physics, and radiation safety. The California CRT is easier because you usually get it after passing the national exam. The Fluoroscopy Permit is moderately difficult because it focuses on safety rules and live imaging. Extra certifications like CT or MRI are harder because they need more training and experience.

Jobs you can get

- Radiologic Technologist (X-ray Tech)
- CT Technologist
- MRI Technologist
- Fluoroscopy Technologist
- Mammography Technologist
- Special Procedures Technologist

Where you can work

- Hospitals
- Outpatient clinics
- Imaging centers
- Urgent care centers
- Doctor's offices
- Specialty medical centers

Salary in California

- Entry-level: \$48,840 – \$76,220 per year
- Experienced: \$93,949 – \$128,770 per year
- Higher pay in specialized departments and cities like San Francisco (\$131,000), Los Angeles (\$100,208), and San Diego (\$98,540).

Daily Job Requirements

- Take X-rays and other medical images
- Position patients correctly for scans
- Follow radiation safety rules
- Prepare and operate imaging equipment
- Check image quality and repeat if needed
- Work with doctors and nurses
- Explain procedures to patients
- Keep patient records and paperwork organized
- Clean and maintain equipment and work area

Summary/Conclusion

- A Radiologic Technologist takes medical images like X-rays and CT scans to help doctors diagnose patients
- It requires education, training, and passing a certification exam
- work in hospitals and clinics using imaging equipment
- This career offers good job opportunities and steady pay in California
- It is an important job that helps doctors find and treat health problems